

5. Sign Regulations

5.1 Purpose and Intent

- (1) This section of the Land Use Bylaw provides definitions and regulations for signs and outlines sign owner responsibilities. Regulations for signs within the City of Airdrie are put into place for the purposes of:
 - (a) Ensuring that signs are compatible with their surroundings;
 - (b) Providing reasonable and appropriate means for the public to locate and identify facilities, businesses, and services;
 - (c) Providing reasonable and appropriate means for businesses to identify their location, advertise goods and services, and promote their development and growth;
 - (d) Ensuring that signage maintains or enhances the aesthetic appeal of development;
 - (e) Maintaining interests of businesses and the general public;
 - (f) Encouraging positive economic development and growth for the city;
 - (g) Ensuring pedestrian and traffic safety, and;
 - (h) Limiting possible adverse effects of signage on neighbouring properties.
- (2) The regulations in this section are intended to prevent overconcentration, improper placement, and excessive height, bulk, number and/or coverage of signs.

5.2 Interpretation and Definitions

In this Bylaw, unless the context otherwise requires:

Sign Definitions
A-Frame Sign means: A self-supporting local advertising sign, typically A-shaped, which is set upon the ground and may or may not have an external supporting structure;
Awning Sign means: A sign which either forms, or is attached to, in whole or in part, a retractable or permanently affixed canopy structure, and includes a sign suspended below the ceiling or roof of a canopy or marquee;
Banner Sign means: A temporary sign constructed from cloth, plastic or other non-rigid fabric, which moves freely with wind movement, and may include its own supporting structure or be attached to another feature or structure. This may include: ▪ Freestanding ▪ Hanging ▪ Light Standard
Billboard Sign means: A large freestanding sign located primarily on major traffic corridors, which directs attention to a business, service, product or event that is located, conducted or produced elsewhere than the site where the sign is located;
Building Face means: Any exterior wall of a building;
Changeable Copy means: That portion of a sign upon which copy may be changed from time to time, either manually through the utilization of attachable characters or replacing the sign copy, or electronically in the case of a sign that contains digital media;
Clear Height means: The vertical distance measured from finished grade to the bottom of the lowest hanging overhead obstruction formed by the Sign Structure.
Clear Pedestrian Space means: The horizontal distance measured from walkway or other path intended to accommodate pedestrian traffic to any part of the Sign Structure.
Community Identification means: A type of sign copy which displays the name of a residential neighbourhood, commercial or industrial subdivision, or other development, and which is typically located at the primary entrance to the subdivision or development;

Sign Definitions
Construction means: A type of sign copy which is used for the purpose of advertising items such as the provision of labour, services, materials, or financing of a development or similar project, and which is placed on the site where the project is being constructed;
Development Marketing means: A type of sign copy which is used to promote a new subdivision or development project, vacant lots, and/or show homes;
Digital Media means: A sign feature where the message or copy of the sign incorporates a technology or method for allowing the sign to contain changeable copy without having to physically or mechanically replace the sign or its components. This includes, but is not limited to, digital signs, electronic message boards, gas station price boards, and time/temperature displays;
Election means: A type of sign copy which is used for political advertising and campaigning during a period of a federal, provincial, municipal, school board election, referendum, or plebiscite. This also includes information signs used to identify and direct traffic to polling stations;
Fascia Sign means: A sign that is painted on or attached to the exterior face of a building and runs parallel to a building face, not projecting more than 0.3m out from the wall;
Illuminated, Backlit means: A sign feature where an artificial light source is used to illuminate the sign from the side or back of the display panel, and may be contained within the structure of the sign;
Illuminated, Exterior means: A sign feature where an artificial light source is used to illuminate the sign from an external source directed to the sign copy;
Lawn Sign means: A temporary freestanding sign commonly made of corrugated plastic or a similar type of material. Typical uses include temporary signs used to advertise election campaigns, yard sales, seasonal retail sales and specials, real estate for sale, and community events;
Limited Use means: A type of sign copy which is used to advertise a location, product, event or activity on a temporary basis, either as a single event or activity over a limited duration of time, or as a regular activity that is for limited periods of time and subject to a recurring schedule (i.e. weekly, monthly). This includes but is not limited to signs for garage sales, open houses, show homes, community events, and similar signs that are temporary in nature.
Monument Sign means: A freestanding sign on a supporting structure or foundation, where the base structure or foundation has an equal or greater length than the sign copy. These are intended to be lower-profile signs and may also include associated landscaping;
Mounted Sign means: A flat sign affixed to a fence or other similar structure, but not a building;
Portable Sign means: A temporary sign mounted on a frame, trailer, stand or similar structure that is easily transported and erected for a limited time. This does not include signs attached to, or painted on, vehicles;
Projecting Sign means: A sign that is attached to a wall of a building and horizontally extends more than 0.3m from the building face;
Public Direction means: A type of sign copy that provides assistance in directing the public either on public or private property, and which provides no commercial message;
Pylon Sign means: A freestanding sign which is supported by columns, structures or other supports that are anchored in the ground independent of a building;
Real Estate means: A type of sign copy which is used for the purpose of advertising the sale, lease or rental of the property on which the sign is located;

Sign Definitions
Roof Sign means: Any sign erected upon, against, or directly above a roof of a building. This also may include a sign placed above the parapet of a building;
Rotating means: A sign feature where the sign, or portion of the sign, moves in a revolving manner;
Sign means: An object or device, including its structure and other component parts, intended for the purpose of advertising or calling attention to any business, product, event, service or thing. This does not include a poster equal to or less than 0.3m ² in area;
Sign Area means: The entire area of the sign on which the copy is intended to be placed;
Sign Copy means: The letters, graphics or characters that make up the message on the sign;
Sign Height means: The vertical distance measured from the highest point of the sign or sign structure to the finished grade;
Sign Structure means: Any structure which supports a sign, including materials used to conceal or improve the visual appearance of the structural parts;
Specialized Sign means: A sign that does not fall within any other definition provided in this Bylaw;
Standard means: A type of sign copy for general advertising, promotion, or information dissemination not otherwise defined by another type of sign copy in this bylaw and not otherwise prohibited by this bylaw.
Temporary means: A time limitation for a sign as indicated within this Bylaw. Where no time limitation is set by the regulations of the Bylaw, it shall be determined by the Development Authority or by the length of a Development Permit approval;
Third-Party Advertising means: A sign feature in which the sign copy directs attention to a business, commodity, service or event that is conducted, sold, or offered elsewhere than on the site on which the sign is located.
Valance means: The portion of an awning or canopy which hangs below the structure and parallel to the building face.
Window Sign means: A sign which forms, or is attached to, or painted on, or installed inside a window, and which is intended to be viewed from outside the premises;

5.3 Sign Permit Application Requirements

- (1) Permit applications for signs shall be submitted to the Development Authority on the prescribed form and shall contain all submission requirements as follows:
 - (a) All dimensions of the sign, including height of the sign and the sign structure;
 - (b) Area and design of copy;
 - (c) Type of construction and finishing to be utilized;
 - (d) Method of support;
 - (e) Details of sign illumination and/or digital media;
 - (f) If the sign permit is for a sign containing digital media, the permit must include the name and contact information of a person(s) having access to the technology controls for the sign, who can be contacted 24 hours a day if the sign malfunctions.
 - (g) Site plan showing sign location in relation to property boundaries and buildings;
 - (h) Fees required for the permit; and